

Competence and Training Framework

Overleaf Publishers Ltd · Co. No. 15735226 · VAT No. 479581629 · Version 1.0 · July 2026 · chainsawcourses.com

1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This framework defines the competence requirements for all roles associated with Overleaf Publishers Ltd's activities, the processes for determining competence, and the requirements for ongoing training and professional development. It applies to the Director, employed staff, and all contractors engaged in activities that could affect product quality, health and safety, information security, or regulatory compliance. Document reference: HRT-001.

2. COMPETENCE DETERMINATION

Competence is determined by assessing: education and qualifications; prior experience and training; demonstrated skills and abilities; and ongoing performance. Competence is assessed at the point of engagement (pre-employment or pre-contractor assessment) and is monitored through ongoing supervision, review, and performance assessment. Gaps between required and actual competence are addressed through targeted training or by restricting activities until competence is achieved.

3. ROLE COMPETENCE PROFILES

ROLE	ESSENTIAL COMPETENCE REQUIREMENTS
Director / Course Author	NPTC chainsaw qualifications relevant to course content (0039-20 to 0039-38 as applicable); knowledge of current HSE/FISA guidance; eLearning instructional design understanding; UK GDPR awareness; platform administration competence; H&S management awareness
Platform Developer / Contractor	Relevant software development qualifications or demonstrable experience; information security awareness; understanding of data protection in software design; platform-specific technical competence (TypeScript, React, Express, PostgreSQL)
Content Reviewer / Subject Matter Expert	Relevant professional qualification in chainsaw safety or arboriculture (e.g. NPTC, NTPC); current knowledge of HSE/FISA guidance and relevant legislation; understanding of assessment alignment principles
Internal Verification Assessor	Understanding of assessment principles and quality assurance; familiarity with IIRSM/RoSPA requirements; independence from the content being verified
Administrative support	Understanding of data handling and confidentiality obligations; platform administration basics; complaint handling awareness

4. INDUCTION TRAINING

All new personnel (employees and contractors) complete a structured induction before commencing their role, covering:

- Organisational overview: mission, values, products, and operating model.
- Health, safety, and wellbeing: this policy; role-specific risks; emergency procedures; incident reporting.
- Information security: Information Security Policy; data handling requirements; password and access control requirements; incident reporting.
- Data protection: UK GDPR obligations; lawful bases for processing; data subject rights; breach reporting.
- Quality management: QMS overview; document control; nonconformance and corrective action reporting.
- Role-specific procedures: relevant operational procedures for the specific role.

5. ONGOING TRAINING REQUIREMENTS

TRAINING AREA	FREQUENCY — WHO
Health and safety briefing (updates, incidents review)	Annual — All personnel
Information security awareness update	Annual — All personnel with system access
UK GDPR and data protection refresher	Biennial or following regulatory change — All personnel handling personal data
First aid (where required by risk assessment)	Per qualification renewal cycle (typically 3 years) — Director / designated first aider
DSE workstation self-assessment	Annual or following workstation change — All screen-based workers
NPTC/professional qualification renewal (CPD)	Per qualification body requirements — Director / content authors
Platform and tooling updates	As required following material system changes — All system users
Management system auditor training (if applicable)	Prior to first audit; refresher every 3 years — Director / lead auditor

6. COMPETENCE AND TRAINING REGISTER

The Competence and Training Register is maintained by the Director and records, for each individual: name; role; required competencies; evidence of qualification/experience for each competency; training completed (with dates and certificates); training gaps identified; and planned training to address gaps. The Register is reviewed annually and at each management review.

7. AWARENESS

All personnel are made aware of: the quality, health and safety, and information security policies and their relevance to their role; the consequences of non-compliance; their contribution to the effectiveness of the management system; and the benefits of improved performance. Awareness is delivered through induction, briefings, and policy document distribution.

8. FRAMEWORK REVIEW

This framework is reviewed annually as part of the management review and following any significant change in roles, regulatory requirements, or identified competence gaps. Controlled under reference HRT-001.

For queries: info@chainsawcourses.com · Overleaf Publishers Ltd · Reg. No. 15735226 · VAT 479581629